

DAY 17: SAVE MONEY AT THE DOCTOR'S OFFICE

I try to avoid the doctor's office like the plague. It could be a yearly checkup or nagging condition—either way, I hate going!

I know I really shouldn't say that, but the more I have to go to the doctor's office, the more copays I have to dish out...and ours are not the cheapest copays you've ever seen. Besides, every time I go I seem to lose a little more faith in the medical system. I'm not a conspiracy theorist or anything, and I *know* not every doctor is like this, but I'm frustrated by the number of treatments that focus only on the symptoms, rather than take the necessary steps to eliminate the actual problem.

This is why over all the money saving tips I'm going to share with you, preventive care is the most essential. Although this phrase is overused and sounds totally cliché, the “apple a day” thing does have some merit, and will keep you out of the doctor's office more than you think. Real food (fruits, veggies, and all that non-processed stuff), alleviate so many symptoms that prescriptions only cover up. In fact, I'm continually amazed at how good I feel when I've nourished my body the right way!

While a healthy lifestyle keeps you on the up-and-up, it still doesn't completely eliminate the need to see a doctor. With relentless allergies, an incapacitating bout of flu, or more severe medical cases like broken bones to contend with, some things are best left to the care of a professional...as they should be.

However, that doesn't mean you're left to pay whatever the doctor or insurance company deems acceptable. The next time you head to your local clinic, try one of these six ways to keep costs as low as possible, and save your hard-earned dollars for the real medical emergencies:

1. KNOW WHAT YOUR INSURANCE COVERS